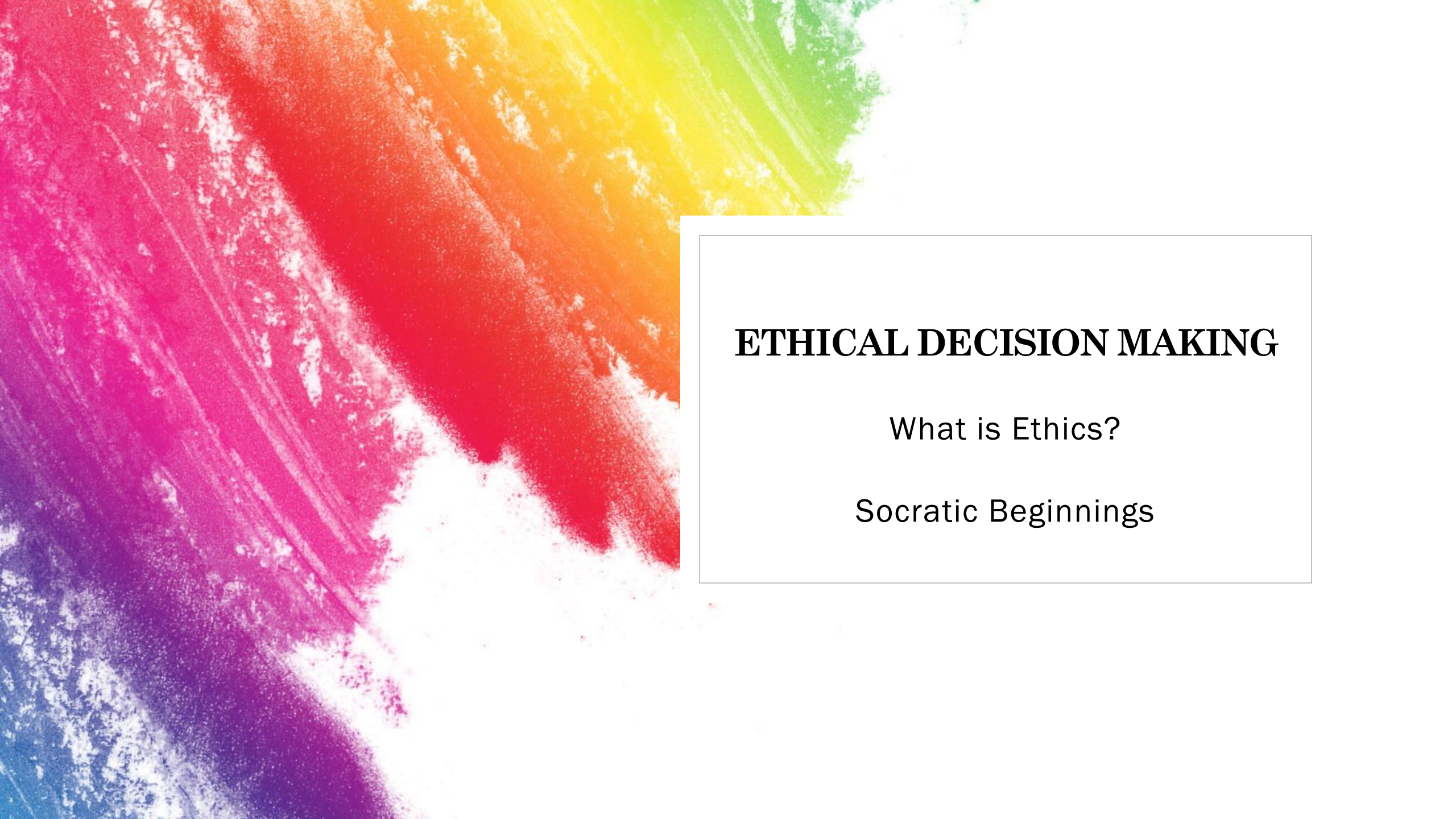




ETHICAL DECISION MAKING

What is Ethics?

Socratic Beginnings

Reflecting on Priorities and Motives

- eating meat or being a vegetarian (or vegan)
- owning a gun
- traditional or electric car
- Taylor Swift travelling with private jet for personal reasons
- marriage
- sacrificing animals for religious purposes
- relations with robots
- What kind of a practical use has an ethics course in a university?

What guides us while making ethical decisions?

- making a decision
 - attention/observation
 - dialogue/discussion (organize your options; review the rights; evaluate the effects)
 - assumptions
 - proposals – actions and policies to be adapted
 - test

What guides us while making ethical decisions?

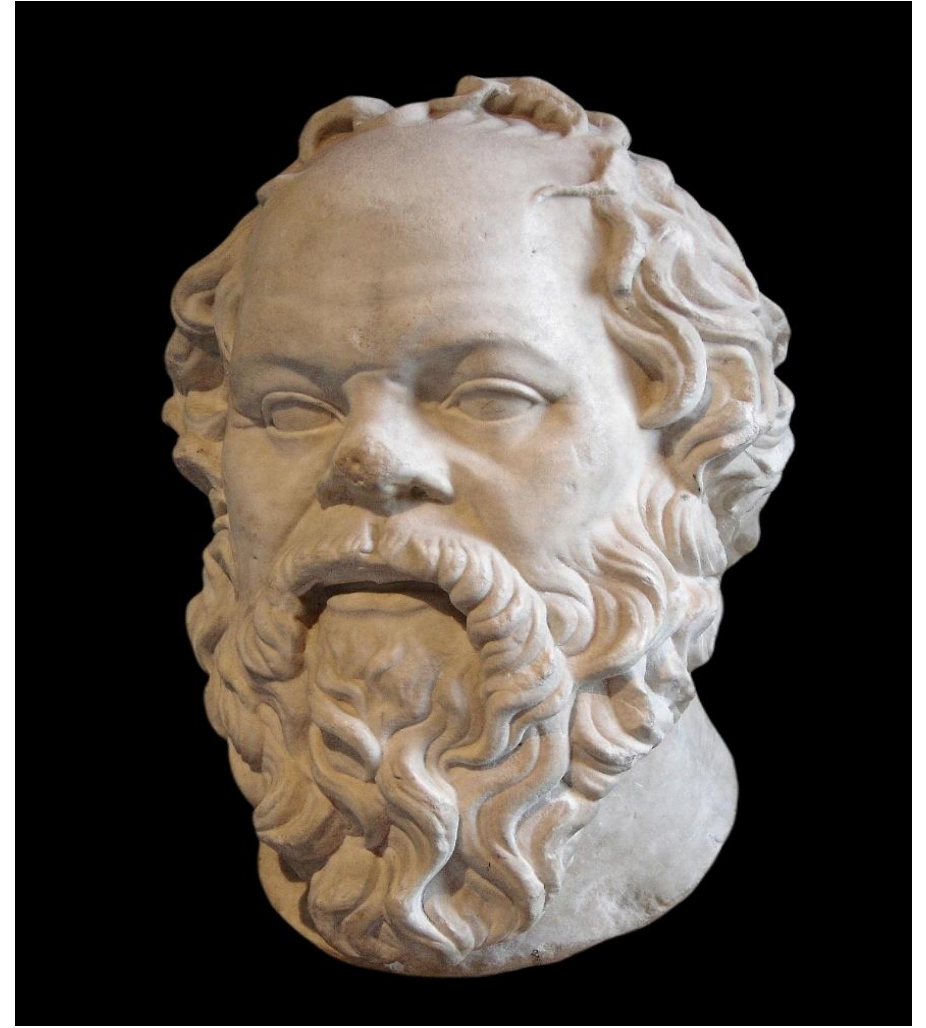
- doing the right thing
 - values
 - virtues
 - principles
 - beneficence (*promotion of welfare*)
 - autonomy (*respect for human dignity; capacity to shape one's own destiny*)
 - justice (*determination of rights, rules, rewards, and dues*)

What is Ethics?

- “*ethos*”
- “moral principles that govern a person's behavior or the conducting of an activity”
 - moral principles, moral codes and standards, ideals, virtues
- moral philosophy
 - right & wrong / good & bad
 - practical knowledge

Socratic Beginnings

- “gadfly over the back of Athens”
- “unexamined life is not worth living”
 - rationality
 - dialogue
 - “know yourself”



The Purpose of Ethical Thinking

- building a personality / character
- shaping our identity
- making choices / judging actions
- changing and improving oneself

Ethical Environment

- ethics → the self
 - “know yourself” / conscience & character
- ethics → the world
 - “ethical climate/environment”

Ethical Environment

- Nuremberg Laws (1935) -- “Law of the Reich Citizen”, “Blood Protection Law”
 - The laws excluded German Jews from Reich citizenship and prohibited them from marrying or having sexual relations with persons of "German or related blood."
 - Ancillary ordinances to the laws disenfranchised Jews and deprived them of most political rights.
 - The Nuremberg Laws did not define a "Jew" as someone with particular religious beliefs. Instead, anyone who had three or four Jewish grandparents was defined as a Jew, regardless of whether that individual identified himself or herself as a Jew or belonged to the Jewish religious community.

Ethical Values between Science and Philosophy: The Case of Ethan Couch

Ethan Couch, 16 years old, drove his car while he was drunk and caused the deaths of four people. “At his trial, a psychologist testified for the defense that growing up in a very affluent, permissive family had not taught him right from wrong. Whether or not this argument was just a lawyer’s clever trick, it highlighted the possibility that we indeed have to be exposed to ideas of right and wrong as children in order to recognize them as significant later in life. (...) In 2016, a Texas judge ordered him to serve 2 years in prison, 180 days for each of the four victims.”

What Ethics is NOT?

- feelings
 - “If something feels right, it must be ethical.”
- self-interest
 - “If it benefits me, then it’s ethical.”
 - egocentrism
- religion
 - “Morality comes only from religion.”
 - dogmatism

What Ethics is NOT?

- what society approves
 - “If most people think it’s right, then it must be ethical.”
 - conformism (*contra* freedom)
- law
 - “If it’s legal, it must be ethical.”
- moralism
 - “Being ethical means judging others and imposing moral rules on them.”

**Turkish Band Manifest Is
Under Investigation for
'Corrupting Public Morals'**



**GEN
ZETTE**

Photo: Instagram | @m5nifestgirls